

Handling your first Zillow lead

90 minutes including practice · 31 screens

Edition 2026-09-14-als-live-v7

Your first-call reference

Use this after class alongside the presentation. Introduction, ALMS, channel choices, and examples are collected here. These fictional examples are adaptable wording, not scripts to recite.

Handling your first Zillow lead

Day 2 · A 90-minute live workshop

Learn how to respond to the lead, lead the first conversation, and agree on a useful next step with the buyer.

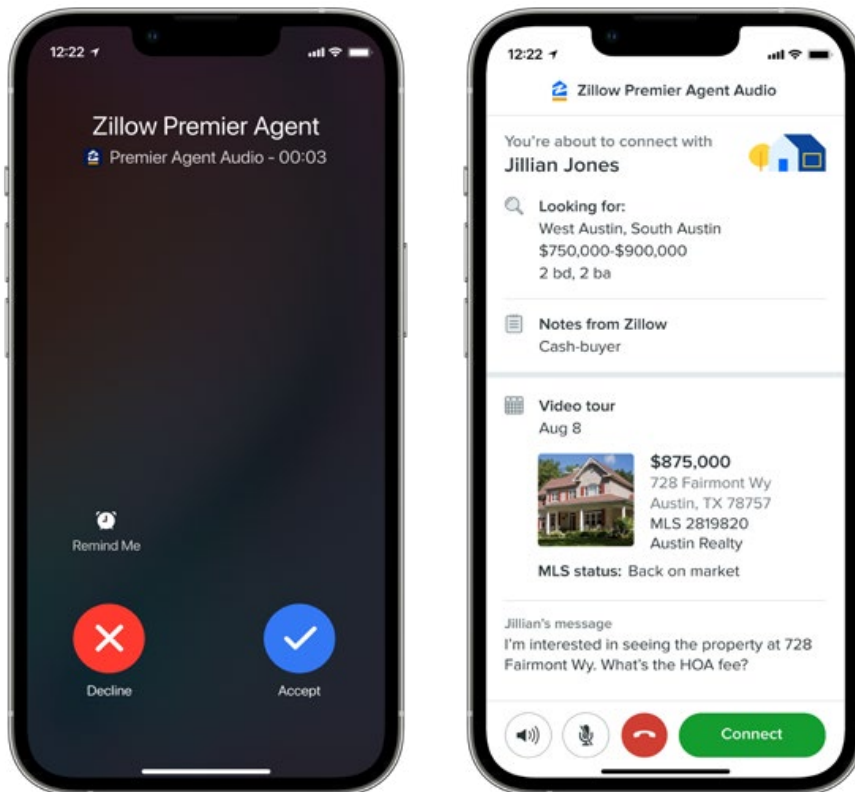
What we will learn and practice

We will work through the job in the order you do it.

- **Receive the lead.** Recognize Zillow's screens and decide how to make contact.
- **Start the call.** Introduce yourself and help arrange the appointment.
- **Understand the buyer.** Ask useful questions and practice listening with a partner.
- **Agree on the next step.** Handle questions, summarize the plan, and practice the full call.

A live connection puts a buyer on the phone

Zillow calls you first. You review the inquiry, then connect to the waiting buyer.



Answer the incoming call. Zillow provides information about the buyer and the home before you speak to the buyer.

Read the inquiry, then connect. In this example, the buyer asks about a property's HOA fee. Begin by introducing yourself and acknowledging that question.

Source: Zillow Conversion Playbook, page 7. Zillow's published demonstration; screens vary by app version.

Real-Time Touring asks you to accept a tour

The phone alert identifies Real-Time Touring. The app then shows the buyer's requested times.



Review the request in the app. Zillow gives you five minutes to accept a time you can attend or pass on the request.

This is not a live buyer transfer. After accepting, review the booking details and contact the buyer about the appointment.

Source: Zillow Real-Time Touring demonstration. Zillow's published demonstration; screens vary by app version.

A standard tour request tells you what the buyer wants

The buyer has asked to see a particular home. They may have supplied a preferred day and time.

Read the request before you contact them. Use the property and preferred time in your opening so the buyer does not have to start over.

"I see you requested a tour Saturday afternoon. Would that still work for you? I'll check the showing arrangements and confirm the details."

A standard tour request may arrive as a live connection or an alert in Follow Up Boss. If the buyer is not already on the phone, your next job is to contact them.

Call promptly when the buyer has asked to hear from you

For a new lead received during TRU's normal 8 a.m.-8 p.m. operating window, call within five minutes unless the buyer gave a different contact instruction.

The buyer just asked for help with a home. A call lets you hear their tone, answer questions as they arise, and begin a conversation about what they need.

Follow Up Boss may already have sent an automated introduction. That does not replace your own call. If the buyer requested a later callback or asked for text, respect that instruction.

If the call goes unanswered, send a personal text

Example: a buyer requested a tour of 418 Cedar Lane. You just called, but they did not answer. The address is fictional.

"Hi, this is [your name] with [your brokerage]. I just tried calling about your Zillow request to see 418 Cedar Lane. I'd be happy to help arrange a tour. I'm available for a call at 4 or 6 today. Would either time work for you?"

Tell them who called, connect the call to their request, and offer a clear opportunity to talk. Use times you can actually make. You are offering a phone call here, not confirming a tour.

Introduce yourself, then use ALMS

ALMS means Appointment, Location, Motivation, and Summarize. It gives the call a purpose without turning it into an interview.

- **Appointment:** Help arrange the visit near the beginning of the call.
- **Location:** Learn where the buyer is looking and why that area works.
- **Motivation:** Learn what they want to change about their current home.
- **Summarize:** Repeat what matters and agree on what happens next.

Demonstration: introduce yourself and offer the visit

Practice buyer George requested a tour of 418 Cedar Lane through Zillow. No time was selected. You can meet Saturday morning or afternoon; property access still needs checking.

Agent "Hi George, I'm [your name] with [your brokerage], a featured partner with Zillow. I'm calling about your request to see 418 Cedar Lane."

Agent "I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which would work better for you? I'll check access for that time."

George "Saturday morning would be good."

Ask permission before asking about their search

In our practice call, George has chosen Saturday morning for the Cedar Lane tour. You have not yet learned what he needs from a home.

Agent "Do you have a few minutes? I'd like to learn a little about your search so I can make our time together useful."

George "Sure."

Agent "Are you moving from nearby, or coming from somewhere else?"

George "We're renting an apartment here in town."

Learn why an area works for them

Our practice buyer George rents locally and wants to see the Cedar Lane home. Ask how that location fits his life.

Agent "What attracted you to this part of town?"

George "It would make my commute much shorter."

Agent “Are you focused on this area, or are there other places that would work for that commute?”

George “This area and the neighborhood just east of it would both work.”

Now you know why the location matters and where a useful comparison home might be. The buyer defined the area; you did not assume it.

Ask what the feature will let them do

Our practice buyer George says the Cedar Lane home caught his eye because it has a larger yard.

Agent “What would you like to be able to do with that extra outdoor space?”

George “I want to grow vegetables. We can’t do that at the apartment.”

Agent “What would you need from the yard for that?”

George “Sun and room for a few raised beds.”

“A bigger yard” is a feature. Space for a vegetable garden explains why it matters. That reason will help you choose better comparisons.

When the buyer says, “I only had a question”

Example: a buyer asks how old the roof is and says they are not ready to schedule a showing. You do not yet have a verified answer.

“Of course. I’ll check the roof information and get you an answer. What is the main concern you’re trying to work out?”

Listen to the concern. If seeing the home would help, explain why and offer a visit. If they still prefer an answer first, agree how and when you will return with the information.

“I can bring the information when we look, or call you after I verify it. Which would be more useful?”

Do not make preapproval the price of a first visit

A buyer who asks to see a home should not have to pass a financial interview before you help arrange it.

TRU does not teach opening the first call with “Are you preapproved?” The buyer does not know you yet, and a private financial question can make the visit feel conditional.

If the buyer raises financing, respond to their concern and offer relevant lender help. The usual later opportunity is the end of the first showing, when the discussion has context.

Answer the question about your role directly

Example: Zillow connects you with a buyer who asks, “Are you the listing agent?” You are not.

“I’m not the listing agent. I help buyers, and I can coordinate with the listing side about this home. What would you like to know?”

Use your actual role and relationship. If the buyer wants the listing agent, offer to help with that connection. Ask whether a later check-in would be useful, then respect their choice.

If the home is under contract, keep helping

Example: during an initial inquiry, you verify that the requested home is under contract. The buyer says its garden space is what interested them.

"The home is under contract. I can ask the listing agent whether a viewing is still possible. You mentioned the garden space; I can also look for homes with similar outdoor space. Would comparing those be useful?"

Be honest about the status. Use what the buyer told you to propose useful work. Do not promise access or claim you have found alternatives before you have researched them.

Summarize the buyer's priorities and the plan

Return to practice buyer George: he wants a shorter commute and garden space. He prefers Saturday morning for Cedar Lane and has agreed to compare another home. Access is still pending.

"You'd like a shorter commute and a sunny space for a vegetable garden. We're aiming for Saturday morning. I'll check access to Cedar Lane and research another home to compare. I'll text you the confirmed details once I have them. Have I understood everything correctly?"

Before ending, confirm the communication plan and explain the applicable touring form. Describe its actual terms and what the buyer will receive.

Listen to the call from the beginning

Fictional case: George requested a tour of 418 Cedar Lane with no time selected. The agent can meet Saturday morning or afternoon and still needs to check property access.

Agent "Hi George, I'm [your name] with [your brokerage], a featured partner with Zillow. I'm calling about your Cedar Lane tour request. Would Saturday morning or afternoon work better?"

George "Morning would be good."

Agent "I'll check access. Do you have a few minutes so I can learn about your search?"

George "Sure. We rent in town, but we'd like a shorter commute and space for a garden."

Continue from what the buyer just told you

In the same practice call, George rents locally and wants a shorter commute and garden space. He prefers Saturday morning for the tour.

Agent "Which areas would work for your commute, and what would you want to grow?"

George "Near Cedar Lane works. I'd like sun and room for raised vegetable beds."

Agent "Would you like me to find another home with that kind of space so we can compare while we're out?"

George "Yes, that would help."

Agent "So, a shorter commute and sun for a garden. I'll check access, find a comparison and text the details for Saturday morning. Is text best for you?"

George "Yes."

Save the details that make your next contact useful

Example: after the practice call, George wants a shorter commute and a sunny garden. Saturday morning is preferred; access and a comparison home still need checking.

FUB note: Rents locally. Wants a shorter commute near Cedar Lane and sun for raised vegetable beds. Open to another home for comparison. Prefers Saturday morning. Text is the agreed channel. Tour access is not yet confirmed.

Next task: Check access, research a relevant comparison, and text George the details. Set the task for the follow-up time you agreed.

Keep working a new lead that has not answered

The first missed call and personal text are the beginning of your outreach, not the entire plan.

Day one: Aim for three to four personal touches, with at least two calls and one personal text in the normal unanswered-lead flow.

First week: Aim for ten total touches, including day one. Make most attempts calls, vary the contact times, and make each text relevant to the inquiry.

Once the buyer responds: Follow the conversation and the plan you agree together. The unanswered-lead quota no longer applies. Honor stated contact restrictions throughout.

Use the request to begin. Use the answers to continue.

You should be able to recognize the lead, start the conversation and leave the buyer knowing what happens next.

Introduce yourself clearly. Help with the appointment early. Ask permission to learn more, follow the buyer's answers, and summarize the plan you actually agreed.

If a question changes the call, address it. If a fact needs checking, say so and follow through. The framework supports the conversation; the buyer's situation determines the next sentence.

Open the Day 2 reference, Zillow sources and practice notes

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Write before the example, practice aloud, and retry one specific part after feedback. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. The form follows the presenter. Submit before the class moves on, or ask the presenter to return to the question.

Explain what happens after you answer

Compare the two Zillow examples: a live connection and a Real-Time Touring alert. What will you do immediately after answering each one?

Describe the next action for each type. Include anything on the screens you want explained.

Respond to a buyer who is at work

A new Zillow inquiry arrives at 2 p.m. The buyer writes: "I'm at work. Please call at 5 about the Cedar Lane home." Write the text you would send now, then state when you will call.

Write your text and the planned call time.

Which opening serves the buyer's request?

A buyer requested a Zillow tour but selected no time. Both agents introduce themselves. Choose the continuation you would use, then explain what the other version could communicate to the buyer.

- "Before we schedule, tell me about your buying timeline and what you're looking for."
- "I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which works better? I'll check the showing arrangements."

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Explain your choice in terms of the buyer's experience.

Write the next sentence you would say

During a first call, a buyer tells you: "We're already in town. We need more space, but we don't want to leave our neighborhood." Write one follow-up question and explain what you hope to learn.

Your next question and what its answer would help you understand.

Practice a short discovery conversation

One person plays a buyer who wants to stay in the neighborhood but needs more space. The other plays the agent, after an appointment has been discussed. Ask permission, then find out what "more space" means.

What did you learn that "more space" did not tell you?

What feedback did you receive, and what changed on your retry?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Explains why the questions help and asks permission
- Follows a buyer answer rather than switching to a checklist

Help the buyer who raises financing

The buyer says: “We want to look at the house, but I’m not sure what we can comfortably afford. Should we speak with a lender?” Which response best fits TRU’s approach?

- “Let’s see the house first. We can discuss the money afterward.”
- “A lender can help you work through that. I can help arrange an introduction as we plan the visit.”
- “Yes. Send me the preapproval letter and then we can schedule.”

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Offer a useful next step after disappointing news

A buyer asks about a home you have verified is under contract. They tell you its location would shorten their commute. You have not researched other homes. Write what you would say next.

Write your response as you would say it to the buyer.

Close a call when the buyer cannot tour yet

A buyer is relocating in two months. They want room for a home office and cannot visit this week. You agreed to email three possible homes and speak Tuesday at 6 p.m. Write the closing summary.

Say what matters to the buyer, what you will send, and the agreed next conversation.

Run a first call and retry one part

Work in trios. The buyer uses an assigned fictional case; the agent responds to what the buyer says. The observer listens for an early invitation, useful follow-up questions and an accurate closing.

What did you learn about your buyer?

What specific feedback did the observer give?

What changed when you tried that part again?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Identifies agent, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose
- Helps with the appointment early while respecting the request
- Asks permission and follows an answer
- Restates priorities and the agreed next action
- Responds usefully to the buyer's question or time constraint

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

Buyer practice cards

Tour request · a home office

I asked to see the Cedar Lane home. Saturday morning works for me.

Fictional buyer: you rent locally and work at the kitchen table. You need a separate work space and want to stay near your neighborhood. Reveal the reason after a relevant question. You are open to a comparison home. Access has not been checked.

Property question · maintenance

I wanted to know about the roof before deciding whether to tour.

Fictional buyer: surprise maintenance costs concern you. The agent does not have verified roof information. Explain the concern when asked. Prefer a call with verified information before booking; do not agree merely because the invitation is repeated.

Relocation · a later visit

We are relocating in two months. We cannot see homes this week.

Fictional buyer: you need room for a home office. You can review emailed properties and talk Tuesday at six. Share details after relevant questions. The useful next step is planning, not a forced immediate showing.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Your coach and approved team workflow.